

Sleep Paper

HIST-103 | The Emergence of Modern Europe

Instructor: Dr. Lindsay O'Neill

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	20%
Start date:	N/A
Due date:	2026-09-15
Group project:	No

Overview (Assignments section)

This 4 page paper will ask you to use readings on early modern sleeping patterns to make an argument about primary sources and/or life in early modern Europe. You will turn it in via your TA's Brightspace. See Brightspace for prompts.

Related Mentions

- This 4 page paper will ask you to use readings on early modern sleeping patterns to make an argument about primary sources and/or life in early modern Europe. You will turn it in via your TA's Brightspace. See Brightspace for prompts.
- to engage with these terms. You cannot make up these quizzes, but your lowest score
- will be dropped.
- Sleep Paper -20%
- This 4 page paper will ask you to use readings on early modern sleeping patterns to
- make an argument about primary sources and/or life in early modern Europe. You
- will turn it in via your TA's Brightspace. See Brightspace for prompts.
- Witchcraft Paper - 20%
- This 4 page paper will ask you to read a number of primary sources detailing early
- modern witchcraft trials and to pick a prompt to make argument about what you read.
- You will turn it in via your TA's Brightspace. See Brightspace for prompts.
- Mid-term - 20%
- The midterm will include ten of the identification terms (I give a definition and you
- give the term, just like the quizzes) and one longer essay (you will be given five
- Kay Daly, "Diverting the Flood of History: Ada Palmer's Inventing the
- Renaissance," Chicago Review of Books, 25 March 2025
- Ada Palmer, "Black Death, COVID, and Why We Keep Telling the Myth of a

- Renaissance Golden Age and Bad Middle Ages," 4 June 2020, Blog by author of
- Inventing the Renaissance (2025).
- Jerry Brotton, "The Best Book on the Renaissance," 31 August 2017.
- Blog by Ada Palmer
- PDF document
- Sep 15-18: Renaissance
- Sep 15: Renaissance Men?: The Highs and Lows of the Renaissance
- Sleep Paper Due by Midnight
- Sep 17: The Renaissance World: Borders and the Beyond
- Sep 18: Readings for Section:
- Vasari, Lives of the Artists: Leonardo da Vinci & Properzia de' Rossi
- Video: The Story of Women and Art, Part 1(1hr)
- Vasari on da Vinci
- PDF document
- Vasari on d'Rossi
- PDF document
- Sep 15: Sleep Paper Due
- HIST 103 Paper 1: Sleep in the Early Modern Period
- HIST 103 Paper 1: Sleep in the Early Modern Period

Prompts (pick ONE)

- be an in-class exam.
- Final Exam - 20%
- The final is the same format as the midterm - 10 identifications and one longer essay.
- This too will be an in-class exam.
- Grading Scale
- A: 100-93; A-: 92-90; B+: 89-87; B: 86-83; B-: 82-80; C+: 79-77; C: 76-73; C- 72-70
- D+: 69-67; D: 66-63; D-: 62-60; F: 59-0
- Aug 25-29: Intro & Black Death
- Aug 25: Introducing the Early Modern World
- Aug 27: The Death of the Dark Ages?: The Medieval Inheritance
- Aug 28: Readings for Section
- What do the patterns of sleep described by Ekirch and Handley tell us about
- structures of power or values held by people in the early modern world?
- What primary sources do Ekirch and Handley use from the early modern period to
- investigate how people slept back then? What do these sources tell us about whose

- sleep patterns are easier for historians to research? And, in turn, what does this tell
- us about structure of power in the early modern world?
- Do a google news search for "sleep" and find articles discussing sleep today (these
- are your primary sources). Are our concerns about sleep similar or different from
- what Ekirch and Handley see? What does it say about the similarities and/or
- differences between our cultures?
- Take on an early modern persona and write a tract entitled "On Sleep" that reflects
- upon what sleep means for them/society and/or gives guidance on how to approach
- sleep. Be sure to use citations to Ekirch and Handley to show us where the
- information is coming from.

Due Date & Submission

- Use the Ekirch article "Sleep we have lost" and the Handley chapters which we read for
- class to engage with the following prompts.

Format Requirements

- roadmap to your paper and tells us your argument, the body paragraphs should start with a
- topic sentence that says exactly what your main idea for the paragraph is and has at least
- two quotes or direct references to the article/s that back up your main idea. This evidence
- needs to be cited through footnotes or in-text citations [ex: (Ekirch, 25)]. See the tips
- below and the paper rubric for more guidance.

Helpful Hints

- Be sure to have a thesis statement in the introduction that tells your reader what the
- argument for the paper is and how you will approach it. It should tell us exactly
- what to expect from the coming paragraphs
- Include direct quotes and/or specific examples from the article or primary sources
- you found. Cite them. This is your evidence and an essay is only as good as the
- support you have for your points. Remember we love direct evidence.
- Each body paragraph should have its own distinct topic, which should be stated in
- the first sentence. Your topic sentence should be centered on an idea rather than
- being descriptive. Don't be vague either. (Avoid: "People slept in different ways"
- [vauge] or "People went to bed at 8pm" [descriptive]; Go for something like:
- "Ekirch uses primary sources written mainly by members of the upper classes.")
- The best paper should do more than just show us x, y, and z about the sleep (if you
- just do that and do it well it is probably a B or B+ paper). You should reach for

- what those points together tell us about society at that time. In the best papers the
- points should build off each other and cumulate in an overarching point.
- Cite all your evidence. If I can write "How do we know?" in the margin of the
- paper it means you should cite something. This includes items found through your
- google search. In-text citations are fine: For example (Ekirch, 12). But if you use
- the internet be sure to have a bibliography if you use in-text citations for them. We
- need to be able to go to the articles or texts that you used.
- Be sure to explain how your evidence connects to your main point (analyze it). Say
- why this quote or fact supports what you are arguing in that paragraph.

Full Syllabus Extract

HIST 103 Paper 1: Sleep in the Early Modern Period Due September 15th, 11:59pm via your TA's Brightspace

Use the Ekirch article "Sleep we have lost" and the Handley chapters which we read for class to engage with the following prompts. Paper: 4pgs, double spaced, should be well written, include a specific thesis that gives a roadmap to your paper and tells us your argument, the body paragraphs should start with a topic sentence that says exactly what your main idea for the paragraph is and has at least two quotes or direct references to the article/s that back up your main idea. This evidence needs to be cited through footnotes or in-text citations [ex: (Ekirch, 25)]. See the tips below and the paper rubric for more guidance. Prompts: Pick ONE to address in your paper What do the patterns of sleep described by Ekirch and Handley tell us about structures of power or values held by people in the early modern world? What primary sources do Ekirch and Handley use from the early modern period to investigate how people slept back then? What do these sources tell us about whose sleep patterns are easier for historians to research? And, in turn, what does this tell us about structure of power in the early modern world? Do a google news search for "sleep" and find articles discussing sleep today (these are your primary sources). Are our concerns about sleep similar or different from what Ekirch and Handley see? What does it say about the similarities and/or differences between our cultures? Take on an early modern persona and write a tract entitled "On Sleep" that reflects upon what sleep means for them/society and/or gives guidance on how to approach sleep. Be sure to use citations to Ekirch and Handley to show us where the information is coming from. Helpful Hints:

Be sure to have a thesis statement in the introduction that tells your reader what the argument for the paper is and how you will approach it. It should tell us exactly what to expect from the coming paragraphs Include direct quotes and/or specific examples from the article or primary sources you found. Cite them. This is your evidence and an essay is only as good as the support you have for your points. Remember we love direct evidence. Each body paragraph should have its own distinct topic, which should be stated in the first sentence. Your topic sentence should be centered on an idea rather than being descriptive. Don't be vague either. (Avoid: "People slept in different ways" [vague] or "People went to bed at 8pm" [descriptive]; Go for something like: "Ekirch uses primary sources written mainly by members of the upper classes.") The best paper should do more than just show us x, y, and z about the sleep (if you just do that and do it well it is probably a B or B+ paper). You should reach for what those points together tell us about society at that time. In the best papers the points should build off each other and cumulate in an overarching point. Cite all your evidence. If I can write "How do we know?" in the margin of the paper it means you should cite something. This includes items found through your google search. In-text citations are fine: For example (Ekirch, 12). But if you use the internet be sure to have a bibliography if you use in-text citations for them. We need to be able to go to the articles or texts that you used. Be sure to explain how your evidence connects to your main point (analyze it). Say why this quote or fact supports what you are arguing in that paragraph.

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